women arrived at the sick bay, receiving both food and medicine. Josef believed it was the former that saved more lives.

“Rose, stay close,” Léa said, taking her sister’s hand as they exited the station. At the back of her mind, she couldn’t shake Josef’s warning that Reinhardt was a wolf. He continued to try and persuade Rose to stop taking the money. *Nothing is free—he’ll demand more from you.* But Rose was already in too deep. She’d been trapped in a web of her own making, unable to stop delivering the reports without arousing suspicion. All she could do was continue bluffing her way through, trying to convince Reinhardt that all the rules were being followed at the sick bay and hoping he would lose interest in all of them.

They walked along Stresemannstrasse, weaving between the workers and deliverymen to avoid being knocked over. A cold wind blew, whipping around the buildings and cutting through their thin coats like a sharp knife.

“Have you ever seen such tall buildings?” Rose asked. “Does Paris looks like this?”

Léa, too, was overwhelmed. Even though Josef had warned her that four million people lived in Berlin, she couldn’t imagine what that looked or sounded like until she saw and heard it for herself.

They were on their way to the Kaffee Post, located off a side street from the famous Unter den Linden. André had written to Rose asking her to meet him there today at one o’clock.

“Are you excited to see him?” Léa asked as they passed a wooden shack on a strip of sidewalk. Men loitered outside speaking a foreign language—Léa figured it was a makeshift barracks for foreign workers.

“A little nervous. What if it isn’t like before and we don’t have anything to talk about or . . .”

Léa squeezed her hand. She suspected Rose was apprehensive about the change in her physical appearance over the last year. It was true that the long hours at the factory had taken a toll. Dark circles under her eyes, her complexion pale, her cheeks hollow. Her clothes had patches at the elbows, and the sisters still wore the same boots they’d worn on the day they left France. Léa wanted to put Rose at ease by telling her that none of these things mattered.

“André cares about who you are inside. He knows what you’re going through because he’s experiencing the same. It will be fine.”